

Illinois Health Department Contact List

COOKd Kitchen. Updated September 26, 2026. For requesting lists of food establishments to use as sales leads.

What this is for

Every county health department keeps a list of the food businesses it permits and inspects: restaurants, school cafeterias, gas stations and convenience stores, grocery stores, nursing homes, day cares, caterers, and food trucks. These are public records. One request can give us hundreds or thousands of leads in a single file.

Your job: contact each health department below, request its list, and track the result. Start at the top; the biggest counties come first.

Step by step

1. **If the table lists an email, you can send the written request right away.** If it says "call to ask," call the food or environmental health number first, using the phone script below, and ask for the best email or form for a FOIA request.
2. **Send the written request** (template below) by email or through their online FOIA form, whichever they tell you. Always say the request is for a commercial purpose.
3. **Log it** in the tracking table at the end: the date sent, who you spoke with, and when they said to expect a response.
4. **Follow up** if you have not heard back when expected. Regular requests are answered in about 5 business days, but commercial requests can take up to 21 business days. Be polite; these are small offices.
5. **When a file arrives**, send it to COOKd Kitchen right away. Do not edit it.

Priority list: largest counties first

#	County	Main cities	Approx. population	Health department	Address	Phone for food / environmental health	Email for the request	Notes
1	Cook (City of Chicago)	Chicago	2.7 million	Chicago Department of Public Health, Food Protection Division	2133 W. Lexington St., Chicago, IL 60612	312-746-8030	CDPHFOIA@cityofchicago.org	About 16,000 licensed food establishments. Chicago also posts free inspection data on its open data portal (data.cityofchicago.org , search "Food Inspections").

#	County	Main cities	Approx. population	Health department	Address	Phone for food / environmental health	Email for the request	Notes
2	Cook (suburbs)	Unincorporated areas and towns that contract with the county	2.5 million (all suburbs)	Cook County Department of Public Health	7556 Jackson Blvd., Forest Park, IL 60130	708-836-8600, option 3	No email posted. Use the online form at cookcountypublichealth.org/freedom-of-information-act , or mail it Attn: FOIA Request.	Covers only part of suburban Cook. By state law, most Cook County towns inspect their own restaurants unless they contract with the county. See the Suburban Cook County section below and contact the larger towns directly.
3	DuPage	Naperville, Wheaton, Downers Grove, Elmhurst	930,000	DuPage County Health Department	111 N. County Farm Rd., Wheaton, IL 60187	630-682-7400	FOIAHealth@dupagehealth.org (FOIA officer Penny Chanez, 630-221-7567)	Posts restaurant inspection reports online. FOIA information is on its website.
4	Lake	Waukegan, North Chicago, Highland Park, Libertyville	715,000	Lake County Health Department	3010 Grand Ave., Waukegan, IL 60085	847-377-8020 (Environmental Services); main 847-377-8000	HealthFOIA@lakecountyil.gov	Main number 847-377-8000.
5	Will	Joliet, Bolingbrook, Romeoville, part of Naperville	695,000	Will County Health Department	501 Ella Ave., Joliet, IL 60433	815-727-8480	FOIA@willcountyhealth.org (or the online form at willcountyhealth.org/foia)	Environmental Health is open 8 a.m. to 4 p.m.
6	Kane	Aurora, Elgin, St. Charles, Carpentersville	515,000	Kane County Health Department	1240 N. Highland Ave., Aurora, IL 60506 (Elgin office: 1750 Grandstand Pl.)	630-444-3040	Not posted. FOIA page: health.kanecountyil.gov/Pages/FOIA.aspx ; call to ask.	Publishes a printable temperature log for restaurants, a good talking point for our sales calls.
7	McHenry	Crystal Lake, McHenry, Woodstock	310,000	McHenry County Health Department	2200 N. Seminary Ave., Woodstock, IL	815-334-4850	Not found. Call to ask.	From a 2019 state list; confirm the number on the first call.
8	Winnebago	Rockford, Loves Park	285,000	Winnebago County Health Department	555 N. Court St., Rockford, IL 61103	815-720-4100 (Environmental Health); main 815-720-4000	foia@publichealth.wincoil.gov (FOIA officer Lavinia Coleman)	Environmental Health is on the 3rd floor.
9	Madison	Alton, Edwardsville, Granite City, Collinsville	265,000	Madison County Health Department	101 E. Edwardsville Rd., Wood River, IL 62095	618-692-8954	Not found. Call to ask.	St. Louis Metro East.

#	County	Main cities	Approx. population	Health department	Address	Phone for food / environmental health	Email for the request	Notes
10	St. Clair	Belleville, O'Fallon, Fairview Heights	257,000	St. Clair County Health Department	19 Public Square, Suite 150, Belleville, IL	618-825-4430	Not found. Call to ask.	From a 2019 state list; confirm. East St. Louis has its own East Side Health District: 638 N. 20th St., East St. Louis, 618-874-4713 (2019 list).
11	Champaign	Champaign, Urbana, Rantoul, Savoy, Mahomet	206,000	Champaign-Urbana Public Health District	201 W. Kenyon Rd., Champaign, IL 61820	217-373-7900 (Environmental Health); FOIA 217-531-2883	Hidden on website. FOIA form at c-uphd.org/freedom-of-information.html ; call Deputy FOIA Officer at 217-531-2883.	Already in progress. About 1,252 food establishments.
12	Sangamon	Springfield, Chatham	196,000	Sangamon County Department of Public Health	2833 S. Grand Ave. East, Springfield, IL 62703	217-535-3145 (Environmental); main 217-535-3100	Email link on the FOIA section of the department's About Us page at sangamonil.gov ; call to confirm.	Also covers Menard County. Says commercial requests take up to 21 business days.
13	Peoria	Peoria, Peoria Heights	182,000	Peoria City/County Health Department	2116 N. Sheridan Rd., Suite A, Peoria, IL 61604	309-679-6161 (restaurant inspections)	Not posted. Call the FOIA officer at 309-679-6101.	Main number 309-679-6000.
14	McLean	Bloomington, Normal	171,000	McLean County Health Department	200 W. Front St., Bloomington, IL 61701	309-888-5482 (Environmental Health); main 309-888-5450	mclean.EH@mcleancountyil.gov (Environmental Health); online FOIA form on health.mcleancountyil.gov	Main number 309-888-5450.
15	Rock Island	Moline, Rock Island, East Moline	145,000	Rock Island County Health Department	2112 25th Ave., Rock Island, IL 61201	309-558-2841 (Environmental Health); main 309-793-1955	Not found. Call to ask.	Illinois side of the Quad Cities.
16	Tazewell	Pekin, East Peoria, Morton, Washington	131,000	Tazewell County Health Department	21306 Illinois Route 9, Tremont, IL	309-925-5511	Not found. Call to ask.	From a 2019 state list; confirm.
17	LaSalle	Ottawa, Peru, LaSalle, Streator	110,000	LaSalle County Health Department	717 E. Etna Rd., Ottawa, IL	815-433-3366	Not found. Call to ask.	From a 2019 state list; confirm.
18	Kankakee	Kankakee, Bourbonnais, Bradley	107,000	Kankakee County Health Department	2390 W. Station St., Kankakee, IL 60901	815-802-9400	Not found. Call to ask.	Ask for Environmental Health.

#	County	Main cities	Approx. population	Health department	Address	Phone for food / environmental health	Email for the request	Notes
19	Macon	Decatur	104,000	Macon County Health Department	1221 E. Condit St., Decatur, IL	217-423-6988	Not found. Call to ask.	From a 2019 state list; confirm.
20	Vermilion	Danville	74,000	Vermilion County Health Department	200 S. College St., Suite A, Danville, IL	217-431-2662	Not found. Call to ask.	Next to Champaign County, easy to service. From a 2019 state list; confirm.

Populations are rounded from the 2020 Census. Phone numbers and emails were checked in September 2026; entries marked "2019 state list" come from an Illinois Department of Public Health list and should be confirmed on the first call.

Counties not listed here: Illinois has about 97 local health departments. For any other county, search online for "[county name] County Health Department environmental health" and use the same process.

Suburban Cook County: contact towns directly

Illinois law requires towns in Cook County to regulate and inspect their own food establishments unless they contract with the county or a local health district. So in suburban Cook, the list usually lives at **the town hall, not the county**. Evanston, Oak Park, and Skokie run full health departments; most other towns handle food inspections through a health, building, or code enforcement office.

How to handle each town: call the main village or city hall number (find it on the town's official website, which ends in .gov or .org), and ask: "Who inspects restaurants in your town, the village or Cook County?" If the town does its own inspections, ask for that office and request its list using the same template. If the county does them, mark the town "covered by county" in the tracking table.

Start with the largest towns:

#	Town	Approx. population	Who inspects restaurants	Contact	Notes
C1	Evanston	78,000	Evanston Health and Human Services	847-448-4311 (or 311 in Evanston); email health@cityofevanston.org	Licenses and inspects more than 400 facilities, including restaurants, schools, day cares, and gas station stores. Posts food establishment data on the city's open data portal.
C2	Skokie	67,000	Skokie Health Department (village-run)	Call Skokie village hall	Runs its own state-certified health department.
C3	Oak Park	54,000	Oak Park Department of Public Health (village-run)	Call Oak Park village hall	Runs its own state-certified health department.
C4	Stickney Township (Burbank, Bridgeview area)	varies	Stickney Public Health District	5635 State Rd., Burbank; 708-424-9200 (2019 state list, confirm)	Separate public health district.

#	Town	Approx. population	Who inspects restaurants	Contact	Notes
C5	Cicero	85,000	Ask the town	Call Cicero town hall	Largest suburb.
C6	Schaumburg	78,000	Ask the village	Call Schaumburg village hall	Major restaurant and hotel area around Woodfield.
C7	Arlington Heights	77,000	Ask the village	Call Arlington Heights village hall	
C8	Palatine	67,000	Ask the village	Call Palatine village hall	
C9	Des Plaines	60,000	Ask the city	Call Des Plaines city hall	Near O'Hare; many hotels and restaurants.
C10	Orland Park	58,000	Ask the village	Call Orland Park village hall	Large retail and restaurant corridor.
C11	Oak Lawn	58,000	Ask the village	Call Oak Lawn village hall	
C12	Berwyn	57,000	Ask the city	Call Berwyn city hall	
C13	Mount Prospect	56,000	Ask the village	Call Mount Prospect village hall	
C14	Tinley Park	55,000	Ask the village	Call Tinley Park village hall	Partly in Will County.
C15	Hoffman Estates	52,000	Ask the village	Call Hoffman Estates village hall	
C16	Glenview	48,000	Ask the village	Call Glenview village hall	
C17	Park Ridge	39,000	Ask the city	Call Park Ridge city hall	
C18	Wheeling	39,000	Ask the village	Call Wheeling village hall	
C19	Northbrook	35,000	Ask the village	Call Northbrook village hall	
C20	Elk Grove Village	32,000	Ask the village	Call Elk Grove Village hall	Large business park with many cafeterias.

Populations are rounded from the 2020 Census. Look up each town hall number on the town's official website, and write it in the tracking table so the next caller has it.

Phone script: calling the health department

"Hi, my name is [Name], and I'm calling on behalf of COOKd Kitchen. We're a food-safety temperature monitoring company. I'd like to request a list of the food establishments your department permits, such as restaurants, cafeterias, and grocery stores, with names and addresses. It's for a commercial purpose. Could you tell me the best way to submit that request, and who I should send it to?"

If they ask why: "We sell sensors that text restaurant owners when a cooler or freezer goes out of the safe range, and we'd like to reach local food businesses."

Calling a Cook County town hall: "Hi, I'm calling on behalf of COOKd Kitchen. Can you tell me who inspects restaurants in your town, the village or Cook County? I'd like to request a list of the food businesses you permit."

Write down: the person's name, their email address, whether they have an online FOIA form, any fee they mention, and how long they expect it to take.

Be patient and polite. Many offices take a few days to respond, and commercial requests can take longer. Never argue, and never call more than once a week.

Written request template (email or FOIA form)

Subject: FOIA Request: List of Permitted Food Establishments

Hello,

Under the Illinois Freedom of Information Act, I request a list of all currently permitted retail food establishments in [County] County, including restaurants, schools, convenience stores, grocery stores, nursing homes, day cares, caterers, and mobile food units. For each one, please include the business name, street address, city, permit type or risk category, and the business phone number and owner or operator name if those are part of the record.

If possible, please send the list electronically as an Excel or CSV file.

This request is for a commercial purpose: COOKd Kitchen is a food-safety temperature monitoring business, and we will use the list to contact food establishments.

Please let me know of any fees before processing.

Thank you,

[Your name]

COOKd Kitchen

[Phone] | [Email]

Tracking table

Fill this in for every health department you contact.

County	Contact name	Date called	Date request sent	Expected by	Date received	Number of records	Notes
Cook (Chicago)							
Cook (suburbs)							
DuPage							
Lake							
Will							
Kane							
McHenry							
Winnebago							
Madison							
St. Clair							
Champaign							
Sangamon							
Peoria							
McLean							
Rock Island							
Tazewell							
LaSalle							
Kankakee							
Macon							
Vermilion							
Evanston							
Skokie							
Oak Park							

County	Contact name	Date called	Date request sent	Expected by	Date received	Number of records	Notes
Stickney Township							
Cicero							
Schaumburg							
Arlington Heights							
Palatine							
Des Plaines							
Orland Park							
Oak Lawn							
Berwyn							
Mount Prospect							
Tinley Park							
Hoffman Estates							
Glenview							
Park Ridge							
Wheeling							
Northbrook							
Elk Grove Village							